DECISION ON THE AFRICAN CONTINENTAL FREE TRADE AREAS (AfCFTA) AGREEMENT
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The Executive Council,

1. **TAKES NOTE** of the Report of the of the AfCFTA Secretariat on the outcome of the Fifteenth (15th) Meeting of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) Council of Ministers responsible for Trade, held from 9 - 10 November, in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia;

2. **COMMENDS** AfCFTA State Parties that have gazetted or domesticated their adopted schedules of specific commitments and URGE State Parties yet to do so, to expedite their domestic process to accelerate continental integration;

3. **ENDORSES** a directive for the AfCFTA Secretariat to revise the study on African Trade with third parties taking into account evolving trade and economic relations across the globe;

4. **URGES** the AfCFTA Council of Ministers to conclude all pending negotiations by 2026 at the latest;

5. **TAKES NOTE** that the AfCFTA Agreement has entered into the implementation phase, and recognise that the Secretariat will require increased resources capacity;

6. **FURTHER TAKES NOTE** of the successful roll out of the Guided Trade Initiative (GTI) and the key role of the AfCFTA Trading Companies (ATC) in advancing market integration under the AfCFTA; and

7. **ENDORSES** Biashara Africa as the premier AfCFTA programme key to advancing continental market integration policies under the AfCFTA and further advancing the interests of the Private Sector across the Continent.

8. **DIRECTS** the AfCFTA Secretariat to provide a progress report to the 7th Mid-Year Coordination Meeting.